

rkforce Strategy Program Manager

- Key Ongoing Programs: Own employment solution model across every country and PEO relationships
- People Compliance Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Cross-functional programs that mitigate risk and drive success, People policy and labor-law related program iterations and implementations (US and EMEA)
- Learning & Development Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Growth & Development Fund, Elevate (Leadership Development experience), Mentorship Programs, etc.
- Talent Acquisition Enablement Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Talent Acquisition metrics and reporting, Interviewer training
 - Job Architecture: Job Architecture for Talent Brand & Enablement Program Management job families
- Talent Brand Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Talent Attraction content, Careers platform management, Talent Brand Events
 - Job Architecture: Job Architecture for Talent Brand & Enablement Program Management job families
- People Communications & Engagement Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Onboarding, Engagement Survey, Values and DZ Awards
- Benefits Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Benefits Renewals and Open Enrollments for Entities, PEO to Entity enablement; Benefits Communication Strategy and Execution
- Compensation Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: ACR, Job Architecture and Comp Calculator maintenance, CLDC meetings; Bonus program management in partnership with Finance; equity program management in partnership with Stock Admin
- People Business Partner Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Org design capability review, Realignments, Quarterly org health metrics, Division-specific programs that drive success

Determining Drive

As our Program Management function in the People Group continues to expand, we anticipate that we will encounter situations where we have multiple Program Managers involved in the same programs or projects. When these situations arise, the Program Manager aligned to the team that is the project or program DRI will be the primary Program Manager and responsible for managing end-to-end program management. Other Program Managers should approach the program as a partner from the lens of the group they are aligned with, collaborating closely with the DRI Program Manager.

Resources

An overview of People Group program management and touchpoints in place to stay connected.

- Repository for Program Management planning resources and best practices
- Slack channel for Program Management Individual Contributors pplprogrammanagers
- Monthly meeting for Program Managers

SECTION: people-group/people-project-program.md

Who can participate

Any team member of the People or Talent Acquisition departments may submit, or participate in projects. Please discuss with your direct manager before taking on one of the projects listed in the issues below. Project work is entirely voluntary, and there should be no pressure for you to feel like you need to participate. Working across different teams is an excellent way to develop your career and see what other team members in the People and Talent Acquisition departments are working on.

Adding a project

Whenever adding a project to the issue board, please be cognizant of the following:

- Does any portion of the project require access to confidential material? Is it absolutely necessary to get assistance on this project? If so make sure the team members assisting in the project have signed an NDA
- Does the project require access permissions to something that the team member may not have? Remember to create an access request for the team member. Please make sure access is removed once the project is complete.
- How much time should the project take? Notate this in the issue.
- Is there a deadline on the project? If so, what is the due date? Add this to the issue.
- Who is the DRI for the project? Make sure the issue is assigned to the DRI and the main point of contact on the project. Also add the tag of the team that the project falls in
- What does success look like? Please define what's expected of the project volunteer up front so the project owner and volunteer have clear goals before committing.

Participating in a project

Participating in a project is entirely voluntary. Please make sure to check in with your manager before picking up a project to ensure that your bandwidth might not change suddenly with an internal project on your own team.

To participate in a project take the following steps:

- Find a project in the issue tracker
- Contact the DRI of the project to let them know you would like to assist in the project.
- Ensure you have the right tools, and time to work on the project
- Add yourself as an assignee to the issue, and comment in the issue that you are working on the project.
- If at anytime you must stop work on the project, make sure to inform the DRI, comment in the issue that you are no longer working on it, and unassign yourself from the issue.
- Once the project is complete, contact the DRI to ensure it completed to satisfaction and that no last minute edits are needed. Close the issue, and add the tag ppp-completed.

SECTION: people-group/people-success-performance-indicators.md

Key Review

The metrics on this page are currently being re-organized according to what the People Group reports out. Below is a link to the most recent Group Conversation deck for Team Members to access in the interim.

[People Group Conversation Deck] To be updated

Tableau People KPI Dashboard

The People Analytics team has a People KPI Dashboard as a SSOT for these metrics. The views from this dashboard will be replacing the current views on this page in the future, but for now they are only viewable to those with a Tableau License here at GitLab. For a more detailed list of People Dashboards please visit the People Analytics Tableau Dashboard Overview page.

{{% performance-indicators "peoplesuccess" %}}

SECTION: people-group/promotion-document-style-guide.md

Assembling a case for promotion can be a time-consuming process. The tips and style principles in this guide will help you prepare a document that presents the evidence clearly, requiring fewer review cycles.

The emphasis on quantification over editorialization has a number of benefits for both the reader and the author:

- It's easier to gradually assemble the document over time, and to understand the level of completion at any point.
- The document reads more confidently and, crucially, more objectively.
- Cases for promotion to the same role are more readily comparable to each other and the job family criteria, with consistent tone.
- The presentation is maximally inclusive, requiring less context on the part of the reader.

Principles for Presenting a Strong Promotion Case

1. Minimize the use of adjectives and adverbs.

- Don't:
 - "significantly improved the performance of the most important Plan endpoints."
- Do:
 - "reduced Time to First Byte (TTFB) by an average of 180ms for the 5 most visited Plan endpoints."
- Why: Adjectives and adverbs are imprecise and make it difficult for the reader to understand the true impact and the person's exact contribution to it.

1. Ensure quantification is appropriate and meaningful.

- Don't:
 - "increased page views by 2 million over a 3 month period."
- Do:
 - "increased monthly page views by 25% over a 3 month period, from 8 million to 10

million."

- Why:

- Ensures that statements pass the "so what" test, requiring no further investigation on the part of the reader.

1. Only use numbered links to list examples, not to describe how the person did something. Instead describe the contribution and link parts of the text.

- Don't

- "brought a critical user feature from the architectural stage right through to General Availability (GA) [1,2,3,4,5]."

- Do

- "created an [architecture blueprint], with a [proof of concept implementation] to validate the proposed solution and aid estimation. As a result, the project was delivered on time in 3 MRs [1,2,3]."

- Why: Avoids the need for the reader to investigate each link individually and figure out for themselves what the person's contribution actually was, often from a large issue or discussion.

1. Focus on ability and impact at the next level.

- Don't:

- "[name] delivered several projects on time by identifying quality implications during development, performing reviews and reaching out early when blocked." (Intermediate Engineer [Competencies])

- Do:

- "[name] delivered several projects on time by proactively resolving vague requirements, collaborating cross-functionally, and mentoring other team-members in a way that enabled them to contribute." (Senior Engineer [Competencies])

- Why: Space is limited and detailing contributions at the current level does not materially contribute to the case for promotion.

1. Business Justification should describe how the person's role will change if promoted, and what that means for the business.

- Don't:

- "This promotion recognizes [name]'s ability to operate at the next level in their role when required to do so."

- Do:

- "With this promotion, [name] will assume ongoing responsibility for technical architecture, initially accelerating [project 1] as project lead and bringing forward completion of [project 2] and [project 3] by 3 months to the end of Financial Year 2026."

- Why: Clearly defining the expected role evolution helps demonstrate the business need for the promotion and how investing in it will contribute to the organization's goals.

Additional Tips for Clarity and Impact

- Avoid unnecessary filler words or phrases:

- Arguably

- In order to

- It should be noted that

- Due to the fact that

- Expand acronyms first time they appear ("Technical Account Manager (TAM)").

- Double-check that links point to the right resource and that it is available to your expected readership.

- Use bullet points instead of prose.

- Avoid sentences over 30 words.
- Stick to the template. If it asks for two examples, give the two best examples.

SECTION: people-group/promotions-transfers.md

Developing talent internally is a key component of our success at GitLab, and our promotion and transfer process is built to support that development in alignment with our values. Team members have two main avenues to pursue career advancement at GitLab: 1) Via our cyclical promotion calibration process, and 2) by applying and interviewing for open positions.

We encourage team members to take control of their own career advancement, and are empowered to own their development. Team members are encouraged to utilize the Individual Growth Plan as a tool to articulate and align with their manager on the skills they want to develop as they think about growing into a different or larger role.

This page captures information about transfers, promotions, realignments.

Definitions

Internal Mobility

Internal mobility is the process by which team members move into open positions at GitLab. When a position is open and posted on the career site via Greenhouse, and then filled by a current GitLab team member, it is classified as 'internal mobility'. Similar to filling a role with an external candidate, internal team member candidates will also follow the same Greenhouse hiring steps and experience a full interview process to enable an informed hiring decision. All open positions should be posted to allow for equal opportunity for consideration.

The type of action resulting from receiving an offer for an open role following the Greenhouse hiring process will depend on the changes in level and job scope:

- If a team member applies for and accepts a position at the same grade, it will most likely be considered a lateral transfer. In most cases, a lateral transfer will not result in a compensation increase, unless there is a significant difference in the compensation structure between the new and prior job families. When a team member moves to a new role, a review of the job level, family, and scope will determine if this is indeed a lateral move.
- If a team member applies for and accepts a position at a higher grade, it will most likely be considered a "promotion" and will result in a change in compensation and/or promotional stock grant. Some job families differ in their job grading and when a team member moves to a new job family, a review of the level and job scope will determine if this is indeed a promotion.
- If a team member applies for and accepts a position at a lower grade, it will most likely be considered a "demotion" and may or may not result in a change in compensation. Some job families differ in their job grading and when a team member moves to a new job family, a review of the level and job scope will determine if this is indeed a demotion.

Upon applying for a new role, it's recommended that team members understand the impact of the change based on their current job grade and family.

Note: If a team member wishes to move from an Individual Contributor to a Management position,

the position must be posted and follow the normal hiring process steps to ensure all interested candidates have the chance to apply. This provides an equitable and transparent process for everyone.

Internal mobility opportunities are dependent on employee eligibility and available open headcount.

- Timelines

- Based on an open requisition and internal hiring process via Greenhouse.
- All positions must be open for a minimum of 5 calendar days.
- At least 2 interviews must be completed before moving to an offer for a candidate internal or external.
- If there is a change in compensation, the start date should fall on the start of a pay period aligned with the team member's country. If the team is in a commissions role, the start date should always align with the first of the month.

Job Detail Changes Due to Business Requirements or Reorganizations

At times, the business may need to change job attributes such as the direct manager or department. These changes may be a result of consolidating teams, creating new departments, or moving team members to report to a new manager. These types of changes are specified as job attribute changes and don't meet the definition of internal mobility, and can be initiated by the current manager via Workday.

Engineering Internal Mobility

For Engineering, please see Engineering Mobility Principles for additional guidelines and justification.

Promotions

Promotions represent one of the most meaningful moments in a team member's career journey—a recognition of their growth, contributions, and potential. For managers, these conversations are among the most impactful you'll have as a leader, offering the opportunity to celebrate achievements and inspire continued excellence.

The promotion cycle is designed to create a fair, transparent process that honors both individual aspirations and organizational needs. Whether you're a team member preparing to showcase your readiness for the next level or a manager guiding someone through this pivotal moment, your participation shapes not just careers, but our culture of growth and recognition.

Throughout this process, remember that promotions are about more than titles and compensation—they're about recognizing potential, celebrating growth, and investing in GitLab's future. Whether the outcome is a promotion or developmental feedback for the next cycle, every conversation is an opportunity to strengthen relationships and inspire continued excellence.

For questions or support throughout the promotion cycle, reach out to your People Business Partner (PBP) or the Talent Management & Development team.

Types of Promotions

In-Cycle Promotions: An in-cycle promotion is any individual that is within the same job family, and has a similar but increased job scope. A promotion is not necessarily defined with a new grade due to differences in job families. We would typically expect a team member to have been in position for at least twelve months prior to being promoted to the next level position within the same job family. This process does not require interview(s), does not create backfill headcount and occurs semi-annually through the calibrated promotion process or monthly for level 5 team members in the Sales Development job family. All in-cycle promotions are processed in Workday and not in Greenhouse.

Internal Mobility Promotions: Internal Mobility promotions occur when a team member applies for an open position and accepts a role at a higher grade/job responsibilities when compared to their current role.

- In order for promotions through internal mobility to occur, approval from the skip-level leader is required.
- Additionally, the aligned People Business Partner should be consulted for alignment and visibility.

Promotion Philosophy

Our promotion philosophy goes beyond traditional "climbing the ladder" thinking. We recognize that growth happens in multiple dimensions—both vertically (moving up levels) and laterally (expanding skills and impact)—creating a career "lattice" that offers diverse paths to development and success.

Our promotion philosophy comprises core pillars surrounding the approach and process alignment to our values.

Pillars

- **Performance First:** Promotions reflect your current performance, not just potential. For an in-line promotion, you should already be consistently operating at the level described in the next job framework before being promoted. While you'd typically become eligible for promotion to the next level in your job family after twelve months in your current role, remember that broadening your skills laterally is equally valuable to your growth journey.
- **Growth Partnership:** Your career development is a collaborative effort between you and your manager. We encourage regular conversations about your aspirations—whether that means moving up the ladder or expanding across the lattice. Your manager is there to help identify opportunities that align with your goals, whether that's deepening expertise in your current area or branching out to develop complementary skills and experiences.
- **Holistic Evaluation:** When considering promotions, we look at both your readiness and the business opportunity. We value team members who take on broader responsibilities and expand their impact horizontally, not just those looking to climb vertically.
- **Transparent Process:** All in-line promotions at GitLab require a promotion document. This transparency ensures everyone understands the basis for advancement, whether it's vertical progression or recognition of significant lateral growth and expanded capabilities.
- **Self-Ownership:** We encourage you to live our efficiency value by being a manager of one and taking ownership of your promotion document, working in partnership with your manager. This applies whether you're seeking vertical advancement or recognition for broadening your skills and impact.

- Equitable Calibration: We calibrate planned promotions twice yearly to ensure fair and consistent review. Through this process, we track metrics to understand if our promotions both vertical and lateral are occurring at a healthy and equitable rate across the organization.

By embracing both the ladder (vertical growth) and lattice (lateral expansion) in our promotion philosophy, we create space for diverse career paths that recognize the many ways you can grow and contribute at GitLab.

Values Alignment

Our promotion philosophy is also aligned with our values:

- Collaboration: Cross-functional lens for feedback and calibration
- Results: Business justification, scope, and team member results are demonstrated and documented to support promotions
- Efficiency: Consistency and scalability in our promotion processes by twice per year planning and calibration. The planning and calibration timing considers existing programs and cycles for the business and aims to embed promotions into cadences where they best align for efficiency.
- Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging: Fairness and equity reflected through a consistent approach and documentation to promotions at all levels in the organization and supported by our job frameworks and Total Rewards URG audit
- Iteration: Process is improved each cycle. In FY24, we moved to a twice per year. We continue to look at ways we can iterate on our process for efficiency and scalability.
- Transparency: Clarity and efficacy of promotion metrics, budget, and guidelines, in addition to transparency in promotion justification through internally public promotion documents.

Processing a Promotion

Most promotions are processed through our twice per year Promotion Calibrations, with exceptions going through Greenhouse or Workday depending on whether or not the individual interviews and accepts a position filling an approved headcount. More info on these 3 methods for processing a promotion below.

Twice per Year Promotion Calibration Process & Timeline

At GitLab, we promote on a twice per year basis. There are three core stages to the promotion process: Planning, Calibration, and Processing.

The Sales Development organization reviews In-Cycle Promotions on a monthly basis, due to the specific promotion criteria for each level within the job family structure. Planning, calibration and processing steps are aligned to the details below.

| Stage | Purpose |

| ----- | ---- |

| Planning | Managers and leaders to review their respective teams to determine promotion readiness, business need, and timeline for the upcoming quarters and project promotions. |

| Calibration | The calibration exercise is an opportunity for leaders (sync or async) to review projected promotions on a twice per year basis. This is an opportunity to create visibility and ensure consistency in who we are promoting and why. |

| Processing | The final stage once promotions are defined, is to determine where to process

the promotion to finalize (this will take place via Workday or Greenhouse). |

Sales Development Process

Sales Development promotions will be reviewed on a monthly basis.

- Planning & Calibration: by the third week of each month
- Processing: promotions must be added to HRIS by the 5th day of each effective month
- Effective date for promotions: 20XX-11-01, 20XX-12-01, 20XX-01-01

Twice Annual Process

Below is the timeline for FY26:

Please note that the Calibration timeline for Senior Director+ promotions will differ slightly from the timelines indicated above, as Senior Director+ promotions are calibrated twice per year at the E-group offsite.

FY26-Q4 (Nov 1)

Below are the dates for the FY26-Q4 promotion cycle:

- Aug 1-15: Team members prepare & submit promotion document
- Aug 18-29: Managers review team member promotion document & conducts discussion with team member
- Sep 1: DEADLINE - All manager promotion nominations must be submitted in Workday
- Sep 2-30: Promotion calibration sessions and promotion approvals
- Oct 3: Compensation grid opens in Workday (promotion approval required prior to opening process in Workday)
- Oct 3-10: Dir+ enters compensation amount in grid
- Oct 13-20: eGroup / PBP comp approvals
- Oct 21-27: Final approvals + statement generation in Workday
- Oct 28-31: Team member communication window
- Nov 1: Promotions go live! ·

Note: All dates are subject to minor adjustments. Any changes will be communicated in advance.

Manager Enablement Sessions (People Manager Pivotal Moments Series)

As part of our new People Manager Pivotal Moments series, the Talent Management & Development team will host specialized sessions focusing on those critical interactions that define your effectiveness as a leader. To support the promotion cycle, these sessions will help managers gain confidence in handling any promotion conversation scenario that comes their way, transforming discussions into opportunities for building trust and driving development.

- Enablement sessions will be available in August - session dates and sign-ups to come

FY27-Q2 (May 1)

Status: Dates are to be determined and posted. Check back!

FY27-Q4 (Nov 1)

Status: Dates are to be determined and posted. Check back!

Planning

FY26 Q4 Promotion Planning will be completed via Workday to maintain confidentiality and enable collaboration across department leaders where appropriate. Prior to the Planning phase in the timeline above, People Business Partners will make sure Workday is up to date before going into the Calibration phase.

Once the Calibration phase by Division is complete, Directors and above will have the ability to enter promotion compensation recommendations into the Workday planning grid. For specific Division calibration meeting timelines, please reach out to your People Business Partner.

Promotion Document

The promotion document is required for all in-line promotions. Promotion documents should not exceed three pages total.

As the audience are other GitLab team members, the text should be written in third person using the team member's name and appropriate pronouns (he/she/they) to highlight the work and skills as evidence of the team member's suitability for the role. A style guide is available to assist in crafting a compelling document. You can utilize a bullet format to ensure that you are capturing the relevant sections per business result or a short paragraph.

In-line promotion documents should demonstrate values alignment, business need for the role, and team member readiness through delivery of impactful business results. The core sections in our promotion document are: Promotion Summary, Business Results/Impact, Values Alignment and Business Justification.

Promotion Summary

This section is a high-level summary (3-5 sentences) of achievements that demonstrate how the team member has the capability to perform at the next level.

Business Results

As our most important value, results are at the core of everything we do.

Please list the 3 most impactful results (accomplishments, initiatives, or projects) that demonstrate the team member's performance at the next level aligned with our values and expectations in the job framework.

Project impact on GitLab / Business Result

Project/accomplishment impact

- Example: The creation of the Org Design Playbook outlines a repeatable process for any organizational change across the company. It creates a collaborative, team member oriented,

communication centric, and results driven format that leaders and People Business Partners can leverage to execute and lead through change. This directly ties to building a high performance culture as a key resource for change management, execution, and stakeholder alignment.

Business result

- Example: Since the implementation of the Org Design Playbook we also implemented a scoring system that allows us to measure the success of the changes we execute. We have seen an increase in the overall average score since the playbook's creation.

Business relevance refers to why the project/accomplishment is important to the company (I.E. related to an OKR? a key investment theme? etc.).

- Example: One of our FY25 Yearlies is related to driving a high performance culture. A key aspect of high performance culture is our ability to manage through change in an efficient and results-oriented way. Organizational design shifts and realignments can have an adverse impact on team member's velocity in delivering results if we are not aligned on an efficient, thorough, and team member oriented approach to execution.

Team member's direct contribution

- Example: Tanuki was the DRI for the global cross functional team, and established all change management communication for the project.

How the team member exhibited CREDIT values in their work on this accomplishment.

- Example: Tanuki demonstrated the Iteration value while delivering this result. They drove a subset of feature teams to commit on delivery timelines to enable GTM motions for the product launch while giving other teams flexibility to deliver iteratively.

We ask that the structure above be followed for business results consistently to ensure that we:

1. Highlight impact: Directly connect our accomplishments to business goals and ties impact and role in projects to next level performance expectations.
2. Cross-functionally understandable: The story-telling structure facilitates more cross-functional understanding of what the team member did, why it matters, and the impact it drove for the business.
3. Add objectivity: Adds objectivity through focus on the contribution, impact, and relevance, in a consistent format, decreasing opportunity for unconscious bias.

Business Justification

GitLab considers both individual readiness and business need when we think about promotions. Managers are responsible for completing the business justification section of the promotion document to include what justifies the need for the team members skills and work to be completed at the higher level. Possible business justifications typically include: more complex projects, additional scope of work required as the team scales, and/or additional responsibility due to XYZ business reason.

Values Alignment

Values are at the core of everything we do at GitLab. It is essential to tie team member achievements and initiatives back to the values they support. Every Value should be referenced in the promotion document at least once with an example of how the promotion candidate contribution to the business result align to the Value. Please provide a 1-2 sentence example for Values that were not referenced in the Business Results section which highlight further how the team member has exhibited CREDIT.

- Please review our guidance on DIB behaviours aligned to each job level which provides examples of how to demonstrate our Diversity Inclusion & Belonging Value

Additional Tips

When creating promotion documents, remember:

- Promotions are based on performance, not growth potential.
- Promotion documents should not exceed 3 pages total.
- Please reference the job frameworks in the handbook for guidance pertaining to expectations at the various levels at GitLab. The job levels should help guide data chosen to be included in the promotion document, in addition to discussion during calibration sessions.
- Please be sure that the promotion document has "comment" access enabled to 'GitLab' to ensure the review and approval process is not delayed. Please delete the instructions associated with each section of the promotion document below before submitting the promotions.
- If you find yourself struggling to articulate your accomplishments, your manager can help support you and provide feedback. You can also consider reaching out to stakeholders for feedback, or meeting with a trusted colleague or mentor to brainstorm.
- It should not include Talent Assessment ratings, such as "Exceeding Performance", as these must remain confidential and only discussed in confidential settings such as Promotion Calibration, talent assessment calibrations, and within reporting structures.

Calibration

Each quarter, Department/Division Leadership and the aligned People Business Partner plan a calibration session to review projected promotions. The goal of these calibration sessions is to set a fair and consistent standard in the Department for promotions, to allow peer reviews, and provide an opportunity to ask questions. These sessions can be async or sync.

During calibration sessions, leaders should be prepared to discuss:

1. Core themes of the promotion document: Values alignment, business justification, business results.
1. Development areas: The promotion document outlines strengths, but we also want to highlight how we will support a team member's opportunity to develop at the next level.
1. Cross-functional feedback: As our business goals and initiatives become increasingly cross-functional, managers should have a picture of how their team member collaborates effectively within their immediate teams, and with their core cross-functional partners and stakeholders.
1. Performance against with the current and (some) next level expectations aligned with the job framework.
1. Competencies: Where available and applicable.

1. Most recent talent assessment (and any relevant changes since).

Calibration should be aligned to the following levels of leaders and people managers:

Promotion Level	Level Calibrated
Under Director level (Job Grade 5-9)	Calibrated at the Department level
Director/Sr Director level (Job Grade 10)	Calibrated at the Division level, with Sr
Director level shared with E-Group for visibility	
VP level (Job Grade 11-15)	Calibrated at the E-Group level

Note that calibration structure may vary by division and department depending on size/scope/etc.

Promotions to Senior Director+

Philosophically, all promotions at GitLab are approached in the same way, follow the same high level process (Planning, Calibration, Processing), and use the same promotion document template.

Promotions to Senior Director+ level (job grade 11 and above) have the following differences:

1. Planning: Senior Director+ promotions need to be added to E-group's promotion project sheet at least two quarters ahead of the desired promotion quarter for visibility. For example, if I want to promote an individual effective in Q1 (February), then I need to have this team member added to E-group's projection sheet within Q3 (latest October). Please work with your aligned People Business Partner, who will ensure the promotion projection is added.

1. Level Scoping: We want to ensure rigor and consistency in our organization design principles and expectations for senior leadership roles. For Senior Director+ promotions, we utilize a scoping tool to evaluate the role (not the team member) for business need and alignment to the Job Frameworks.

1. Cross Functional Feedback: We require at least 3 examples of cross functional feedback when reviewing Senior Director+ promotions. This feedback will not be made public and will only be reviewed by the calibration committee, PBP, direct manager and team member.

- All three of the business results highlighted in the promotion document should have feedback provided from at least one cross functional team member.
- Feedback providers should have direct experience working with the team member on one or more of the business results highlighted in their promotion document as a project team member, DRI, or stakeholder.
- Feedback provider is not in the same reporting line as the manager (I.E. not team member's manager, skip level, etc.)
- Feedback providers must be cross-functional. When determining the most appropriate team members to provide feedback, the core focus should be on who worked most closely with the promotion candidate on the business results highlighted in the promotion document.
- Feedback providers should be at or above the target promotion level. Feedback providers can be individual contributors or people managers at or above the target promotion level. The reason we require feedback providers to be at or above the target promotion level is to ensure they are able to speak to business results and collaboration in the context of next level expectations as team members who are already operating at the next level.

- Feedback will be captured in this template, separate from the Promotion Document and will be reviewed as part of the calibration discussion. Feedback will be summarized, and it is not required to provide specific names of the feedback providers.

Feedback question guidance:

1. Please provide feedback on X delivery of Y business results, and collaboration with you and/or your team.
1. Specifically highlight performance against the Job Frameworks, CREDIT Values and HPT Pillars

1. Calibration: All Senior Director level promotions are calibrated at the Divisional VP+ leadership level, as opposed to at the Department level. Vice President level promotions are calibrated at E-group. The calibration timeline will align to the timing of the E-group offsite or extended monthly meeting, and will thus differ from the Calibration timeline of the rest of the organization. All promotion documents, feedback summaries and scoping tools need to be completed and shared with the E-group for visibility and preparation at least 2 weeks before the off-site date.

The only exception to this process is when there is an open budgeted and publicly advertised vacancy for a Director or above level role that an internal team member interviews for and is offered. If external candidates have been considered and interviewed, and the internal candidate earns the role through a standard hiring process (screening, full interview process) then the recruiter may make an offer to the candidate as soon as the offer is approved. There should be no difference in the timing or process of making and accepting an offer for open roles between internal and external candidates.

Promotion Metrics

GitLab tracks the following promotion metrics in Tableau

Internal Mobility

GitLab tracks Internal Mobility rate. Market data indicates a 15% rolling promotion rate as the guideline for what we should see on average across the company for promotions. This is a guideline, not a cap.

Average % Compensation Change

GitLab targets an average of 5-10% compensation change in general for promotions. This metric is in place to ensure we are consistent and equitable across the company when allocating promotion compensation raises to team members, in addition to ensuring competitive and meaningful promotion increases across the board.

Budget Impact (see below)

FP&A tracks budget impact by Department/Division twice per year.

Promotion Budget

Promotion budget is held at the division leader level and is scaled down to the director and

above level for planning in Workday.

Please review the Compensation Program Budget to understand how the promotion budget is allocated and the process to review potential tradeoffs if divisions/departments are over/under budget for any given quarter.

Promotions Processed Outside of the Twice Per Year Promotion Calibration Process

Certain types of promotions can be handled outside of the Twice Per Year Promotion Calibration process:

1. Application to a new, approved headcount in Greenhouse:
 - Internal candidates go through an interview process as defined further in the Greenhouse Promotions/Transfers section.
1. Promotions stemming from individuals in interim/acting roles.
1. Exceptions that are outside of the twice per year process and not aligned with any of the types listed above.

How to Process an Exception: Submitting an out-of-cycle Promotion request in Workday

For exceptional situations where a promotion is not handled through the twice per year promotion calibration process or via an open requisition in Greenhouse, managers can work with their People Business Partner to submit promotions through Workday. Managers should reach out to their PBP via email and include a promotion document, justification for the exception, and next level manager approval for any compensation increase recommendations above 10%. Once the People Business Partner approves an exception, the promotion can be processed and the People Business Partner can submit the promotion in Workday. See the Workday Guide for help with submitting the changes.

Exception Approvals

| Promotion Level | Approvals Required |

| ----- | ---- |

| Under Director level (Job Grade 5-9) | 1) Direct Manager, 2) Department Head, 3) People Business Partner, 4) Total Rewards, 5) FP&A |

| Director+ level (Job Grade 10-15) | 1) Direct Manager, 2) Department Head, 3) People Business Partner, 4) Total Rewards, 5) FP&A, 6) E-Group Leader |

Approvals for the Director+ level off-cycle promotion exceptions require E-Group approval, and off-cycle promotions for levels under Director require approval through Department head.

Regardless of the promotion level, it is critical that leaders work with their People Business Partner, Total Rewards, and FP&A as outlined to identify tradeoffs we can review to fund the promotion.

FY25 CTO Organization Promotion Guidance

Required Documentation

In the CTO Organization, we will follow the company process for promotions and use the standard

Promotion Document. We will require business justification to be filled out for every role, regardless of seniority. There is specific guidance that we'd like our managers to focus on when considering promotions in this fiscal year. Please see below. Please note, effective for the FY25 Q3 promotions, peer feedback is not required for promotion consideration. We may re-evaluate this component in the future.

CTO Timeline for FY25-Q3

- 2024-06-10 to 2024-06-21: Direct managers of promotion nominees complete the Promotion Document after discussing the individual's readiness with peers, stakeholders, and fellow team members. Completed documents are shared with Kristina Bullock and Jess Durbin by 2024-06-21 (End of Business Pacific time).
 - Please note: direct managers can start working on promotion documents prior to 2024-06-10. This is the start of the company-wide planning period.
- 2024-06-24 to 2024-07-10: Department level calibrations (facilitated by PBP) followed by a CTO Leaders Calibration.
- 2024-07-16 to 2024-08-01: Approved promotions are entered into Workday, Comp review is completed and final approvals are obtained.
- 2024-08-01: Promotions effective in Workday.

Context Setting for Managers

As a leader, if your team member's promotion is approved, you will need to reset expectations with the individual and will likely need to make changes to accommodate the growth in seniority of the team. Before you write up the rationale, thinking through what these changes will entail will help you prepare the best business justification. A positive result not only changes the expectations of the individual but also of the manager, current and future, for how work should get done.

Guiding Questions for FY25 Promotions

Please refer to the GitLab Job Frameworks, Engineering IC Career Matrix and the Engineering Leadership Job Families to view the team member's current responsibilities, and future expectations after the promotion.

1. How will this team member's role change if the promotion is approved? What work will they stop doing in order to make room for their increased responsibilities? It is expected that this be included in the business justification and that these decisions are a benefit to the team, stage and company, depending on the level of the promotion.

1. Example: Tanuki is ready to be a senior engineer. This is displayed by the fact that she streamlined her own work by developing an evaluative framework for adding telemetry and quality metrics that will identify regressions before they are put into production. This has improved the quality of her work, and now as a senior engineer she will lead the rest of the team to ensure they are setting the appropriate quality bar for all the team's feature before they are pushed to production. As a senior engineer she will continue to work across the team to incorporate this new evaluative framework in how the team will work. She has the opportunity to expand this across multiple teams but that will be part of her development plan for continued growth.

2. How will the team member work differently if the promotion is approved?

1. Example: Tanuki currently receives their work items from the Quad, but in the new role Tanuki will be expected to work x-functionally to identify potential work that should be prioritized and incorporated into the planned milestones. Tanuki will be able to present the challenges and rationale for the work to be appropriately prioritized and will be able to execute quickly for GitLab to realize the benefit of this new work.

3. Have you considered how the team might function differently with this team member in a higher level role?

1. Additional Detail: All promotions increase cost and expectations of a given team and/or project. How will you and the person ensure the return on this increased investment of the company in this person/team/project. Elaborating on the commitment and changes that will occur with a positive outcome will benefit the decision makers to have confidence that this promotion will produced improved outcomes for all parties.

4. Do I need this many "X" level (i.e. Senior Engineer) team members in my current team state? Is there enough work at that level to be done?

Security Promotion Process

Giving and receiving feedback is a critical part of building high performing teams. Feedback from team members on key business results achieved is an important data point to consider when assessing team member promotion readiness. In an effort to continue to foster a feedback culture within the Security division and ensure we are calibrating collaboration effectiveness through business results, starting in FY25 Q3 we embedded a formal feedback touchpoint into our promotion process for the division. Please note that the feedback does not determine whether the team member is ready for promotion in isolation, but is rather a data point to consider throughout the promotion planning and calibration process.

The steps below outline the process promotion candidates should follow to request feedback as part of our bi-annual promotion process, key due dates, and helpful resources for both promotion candidates and feedback providers to review.

1. Team members aligns with manager on promotion readiness and candidacy

- Ahead of requesting feedback, team members should have a conversation on promotion readiness with their manager. If there is alignment on readiness for the upcoming promotion cycle between both manager and team member, the team member qualifies as a "promotion candidate". Managers should ensure that the CISO direct in their leadership chain is also aware and supportive of the promotion candidacy before kicking off the process. This also creates space for early feedback.

- Due date: 2024-10-31

2. Team member completes their promotion document

- The promotion document completion should be team member driven with manager support, review, and feedback. Ahead of requesting feedback, the promotion document should be complete, as it will serve as the baseline to provide feedback. Team members should ensure their manager has reviewed their promotion document and is aligned with the content ahead of requesting feedback.

- Due date: 2024-11-08

3. Team member makes a copy of feedback form template

- This Google Form provides a template for promotion feedback collection across the Security division to ensure consistency in the format and questions to facilitate more consistent and equitable calibration process. This process focuses specifically on feedback related to the business results section of the promotion document to ensure feedback is consistently tied back to key deliverables that demonstrate next level performance.
- Each promotion candidate should make a copy of this form to use to collect feedback from their respective feedback providers.

4. Team member identifies stakeholders for feedback request

- Team members should ideally select 3-4 distinct team members to provide feedback across the three business results highlighted in their promotion documents, but are required to select at least 2 distinct team members to provide feedback. All three of the business results highlighted in the promotion document should have feedback provided from at least one feedback provider. Team members should review their proposed feedback providers with their manager before sending out the feedback form to ensure alignment.
- Requirements for feedback providers are:
 - Feedback providers should have direct experience working with the team member on one or more of the business results highlighted in their promotion document as a project team member, DRI, or stakeholder.
 - Feedback provider is not in the same reporting line as the manager (I.E. not team member's manager, skip level, etc.)
 - Feedback providers can be cross-functional or within the division, with a mix of both being the preference and recommendation. The core focus when thinking through who the most appropriate team members to provide feedback are is to reflect on who worked most closely with the promotion candidate on the business results highlighted in the promotion document.
 - Feedback providers should be at or above the target promotion level (I.E. if a Security Engineer is targeting a Senior Security Engineer promotion, the feedback provider's level should be Senior Security Engineer or higher). Feedback providers can be individual contributors or people managers at or above the target promotion level. The reason we require feedback providers to be at or above the target promotion level is to ensure they are able to speak to business results and collaboration in the context of next level expectations as team members who are already operating at the next level.
 - You can reference our job grades for a refresh on the people management and individual contributor corresponding job levels, GitLab Job Frameworks for an overview of key differences by level company-wide, and our job families as a resource for Security-specific differences in expectations by level.
 - If you need assistance meeting these requirements for selecting feedback providers, please discuss with your manager for support.
- Due date: 2024-11-14

5. Team member sends out feedback form copy to feedback providers

- This references the form promotion candidates made a copy of in Step 3.
- Team members can leverage this as a structure to include in the feedback request if helpful: Hi [team member name], I am currently under consideration for a promotion to [next level job title]. I would really appreciate your feedback on our work together, specifically on results and our collaboration related to [name business result]. Please complete this feedback form by [insert due date]. You can read more about the feedback process [link this handbook section].
- For promotion candidates requesting feedback and for team members providing feedback, we recommend that you review our Guidance on Feedback ahead of the process kicking off. The S-B-I model can be a helpful framework in ensuring feedback is structured in a clear and digestible

way.

Feedback will be ongoing from 2024-11-15 through 2024-11-29. If team members are prepared to send out the feedback form to stakeholders prior to 2024-11-11 they may do so. All feedback needs to be obtained by 2024-11-29.

6. Team member and manager analyze feedback

- Team member shares the feedback obtained with their manager and they discuss and analyze themes and trends
- Team member and manager compile themes to share with CISO direct. Leverage this template for theme compilation and analysis to ensure consistency. Analysis should focus on key themes and feedback provided in the Google Form.

- CISO direct has the opportunity to review, provide feedback, and ask any clarifying questions to ensure they are able to represent the feedback in the CISO directs calibration session.

- Due date: 2024-12-06

7. CISO direct adds feedback summary to calibration spreadsheet

- CISO direct is responsible for adding the promotion feedback analysis compiled in Step 6 to the CISO directs promotion calibration spreadsheet to ensure visibility ahead of the calibration session. The spreadsheet is titled Security Promotion Projections for reference.

- Add the complete feedback analysis for each promotion candidate to column J and ensure that the CISO, CISO directs, and the Security People Business Partner have access.

- Due date: 2024-12-11

8. Calibration session occurs

- Calibration is scheduled for the week of 2024-12-16 where CISO directs calibrate promotion candidates across the division.

- CISO direct is responsible for following up with the promotion candidate's manager to provide feedback and key takeaways from the calibration session.

9. Managers communicate promotion status

- Promotions are effective 2025-02-01 and the communication window is 2025-01-27 to 2025-01-31 aligned with the company-wide timeline

- Managers will communicate successful or unsuccessful promotion with team members directly. For unsuccessful promotions, clear feedback should be provided to the team member.

Feedback Confidentiality

A goal through this process is to continue to facilitate opportunity to provide more regular and ongoing feedback and flex the feedback muscle as a division. We encourage team members to own the feedback that they provide to strengthen relationships, invest in each other's growth and development, and provide the opportunity for team members receiving the feedback to ask clarifying questions if needed.

The feedback form asks for feedback provider's information, so promotion candidates and their managers will have visibility into specifics of the feedback provided. At the CISO directs calibration session we will review themes in this structure.

Feedback provided will not be shared outside of the promotion candidates' leadership chain, CISO directs group, and aligned People Business Partner.

Resources

An overview of key resources highlighted above for the Security promotion feedback process.

These are either resources that will be used during the process, or resources we recommend team members and feedback providers review ahead of kicking off the process.

- GitLab Job Frameworks
- Security job families
- Guidance on Feedback
- GitLab job grades
- Business results
- Promotion document
- Feedback Provider Google Form
- Feedback analysis template

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Hiring for VP+ Roles

In order to ensure a consistent level of review for both internal promotions and new leadership roles, any net new VP and above "To be Hired" roles will be reviewed and approved by e-group. Senior leaders should partner with their People Business Partner to create a justification document for their proposed role. The justification document allows for e-group to better understand the business need for the role and how it will align within the organization.

This review is part of our organizational design discussions that occur during the e-group offsite.

Proposed roles can be reviewed as soon as the organization has visibility to the business need. However, if the need for a new VP+ role comes up outside of those organizational design discussions, it can be reviewed during the weekly e-group meeting to continue to ensure that we are agile and competitive in our hiring practices.

The justification document needs to be used when:

1. We decide to backfill an existing role at a higher level (VP+)
1. We open a net new headcount for a VP+ role (that is was not accounted for in the current fiscal year headcount plan)

Process for Managers: Requesting a Promotion

1. Determine whether the promotion change should be processed through the twice per year promotion cycle or through Greenhouse
1. If proceeding with the twice per year promotion cycle, work with your People Business Partner and Leadership to recommend the promotion ahead of the planning process so the team member included in planning and calibrations. Ensure the Promotion or Compensation Change Document has been created at this time.
 - If the team member you are recommending a promotion for is director or above, please refer to the promotions to director and above.
1. If the promotion/compensation change should be processed through Greenhouse, please follow the steps outlined in the Greenhouse Promotions/Transfers Process section.

1. If the promotion is considered an exception, please follow the steps outlined in the How to Process an Exception: Submitting an out-of-cycle Promotion request in Workday.

Things to consider before you start the process:

- There will be situations when a team member is ready to move to the next level through a promotion, however, due to the nature of the business, that particular role or next level may not be available. For example, the team member is ready for a Manager or Director role, however, the business does not have the need, budget or scope for an additional manager/director at that time. The position may or may not become available in the future.
- If the vacancy is being advertised via the jobs page the individual must submit an application for the role. Similarly, if there is no vacancy posting, one must be created and shared on the new-vacancies Slack channel so that everyone has the opportunity to apply and be considered.

Recommending a Compensation Increase

At GitLab, we ensure that promotions are impactful from the compensation perspective, stay within range of the compensation calculator, and are equitable to peers in the same role. Managers propose a recommended increase in cash compensation for their direct report using the compensation calculator. If you have any questions feel free to reach out to your People Business Partner or the Total Rewards Team.

Promotion Compensation Guidelines

- When a team member is promoted from one level to the next in the same job family, it is typical to be brought between the minimum and median of the compensation range.
- The Total Rewards Team typically recommends a 5%-10% increase as part of the promotion to cash compensation. Additional equity is fixed based on equity for promotions.
 - Benchmarking data relays that typically 4-8% of your population will be promoted annually with an average of a 4.1% increase to base salary.
- Any promotions with the following conditions will require additional justification to the Total Rewards team and executive approver. Please add the business justification as a comment in the promotion worksheet.
 1. An increase of more than 10%
 1. The promotion exceeds the range in the compensation calculator.

Transfer Compensation Guidelines

When reviewing compensation for a transfer in Greenhouse, the Total Rewards team will ensure internal equity among like roles ahead of approving the offer details using the following general guidelines:

1. Lateral Transfer (different or same job family, same grade): Typically we expect a team member to receive no increase for a lateral transfer. This includes team members receiving a change in territory, segment, or specialty with no change in grade or job level.
1. Promotional Transfer (different or same job family, higher grade): Typically we expect team members to receive a 5-10% increase (aligned to the promotional expected increase).
1. Other Transfer types: There are other transfers that can be reviewed on a case by case basis. For example, if someone is transferring to a lower grade in a different or same job

family, compensation may be adjusted down to ensure alignment to market rates for the role. Please tag the Total Rewards team in Greenhouse to conduct a review.

Workday Out-of-Cycle Promotion Approval Process

This section describes the approval chain after the People Business Partner submits a promotion request in Workday.

1. The changes will route for approval to the manager, next level manager, and e-Group leader.
1. If the request is approved, the People Connect Team will stage the Job Change Letter in DocuSign.
1. DocuSign will prompt the manager to discuss the promotion with the team member. The Manager will communicate the change to the team member in their 1-1 meeting by sharing the job change letter on the call. The Manager and the team member will process/sign the letter. Following the signatures, the manager will announce the promotion on the slack team-member-updates channel. In the announcement the manager will describe how the individual met the promotion criteria and offer congratulations.
1. For change of departments and managers, People Connect Team members will create a Organization Change Checklist Issue.

For People Connect Team: Processing Promotions, Internal Transfers & Compensation Changes

1. If the request is approved through Workday, the People Connect Team will create the Job Change Letter, whereas if the request is through Greenhouse the People Connect Team will be notified via the People Connect team email inbox that the Job Change Letter has been created by the CES team and signed.

Job Change Letter

1. For GitLab entities and Independent Contractors a job change letter may be required, as per the steps mentioned below. If the team member is employed by a PEO, notify the applicable PEO either by email or for remote.com via their dashboard. See the People Connect 1password vault for contact details.
1. Review the Signature requirements per country and process the job change letter accordingly. Please note not all entities and country locations require Job Change Letters (for example team members in the US will not receive a Job Change Letter).
1. Make a copy of the applicable Job Change Letter template and enter all applicable information based on the Workday request and add the applicable Signatory or Company Signature Stamp. The effective date is as follows:
 - For sales personnel with a variable change, the effective date is always the 1st of the month regardless of their entity.
 - If the team member is making a lateral move where there is no change in compensation, then the start date can be any Monday.
 - For US team members, the effective date should be either the 1st or the 16th. If the payroll cut off date has passed for the current pay period, the effective date should be made for the start of the next pay period. The GitLab Inc and Federal Payroll calendar should be referenced when determining the effective date.
 - For example, if the change is being processed on June 22, since this date is before the payroll cut off date of June 23, the effective date should be June 16.
 - If the change instead is being processed on June 25, the effective date should be July 1

since this is after the payroll cut off date.

- For Canada team members, the effective should be the start of the pay period closest to, but not after the payroll cut off date depending on when the change is processed. The GitLab Canada Corp Payroll calendar should be referenced when determining the effective date.

- For example, if the change is being processed on June 15, since the payroll cut off date of June 6 has passed, this would go to the next pay period with a cut off date of June 20. The corresponding start of the pay period for the June 20 cut off date is June 21 so June 21 should be the effective date.

- For all other changes, the effective date should be the first of the current month if processed on or before the 8th of the month and the first of the next month if processed after the 8th of the month.

- For example, if a GitLab Ltd team member has a change being processed on June 7, this would be effective June 1.

- If the change was instead being processed on June 15, this would be effective July 1.

1. If the team member is employed in France please share the Job Change Letter with the Legal Employment team so they can confirm the classification in the letter.

1. If only the company stamp is required the letter should get emailed to the team member's manager to communicate the change

1. If e-signatures are required stage the letter in DocuSign and add the following team members to sign via their GitLab email addresses:

- Add radio button (Delete the additional one) for the Manager to communicate the change to the team member by sharing the job change letter during the 1:1 Zoom call and then again add one radio button to (Delete the additional one) announce on the team-member-updates Slack channel.

- Add signature field for the team member

- Add sign date field for the team member

- Note: Make sure that a) "Set signing order" option has been selected while preparing the doc, and b) Select radio button instead of checkboxes as only radio button allows you to select the required field/mandatory field option. This prohibits the Manager to process the letter without checking the tasks on the letters.

1. Save the signed letter to the respective team members Documents Tab within their Workday Profile.

1. If the here mentioned criteria for an Organization Change Checklist is met the People Connect Specialists will receive an alert from Workday and ensure that an issue is opened for the transitioning team member.

Interim and Acting Roles

Interim

As part of the career development structure within the Engineering division, interim and acting role opportunities occasionally arise. For more information on how interim and acting roles fit into Engineering career development, please reference the Engineering career development handbook page. For information on the interim and acting processes, please continue reading below.

Beginning Interim Period

As highlighted in the Definition section, all interim roles (regardless of the number of applicants) should go through the Greenhouse application and interview process. The interview

process steps will be determined by the hiring manager and next level leader. This will contain several steps of the sta